

Furman University Pauper Players Constitution & Bylaws Updated Spring 2024

Founding

In 1992, an ambitious and talented sophomore named Mary Mitchell Campbell noticed that one form of the arts was glaringly absent from Furman's campus—musical theatre. At the time, a musical had not been staged at Furman since a production of "South Pacific" twenty-seven years prior. Campbell had found her mission; she gathered a group of interested friends and vowed to end musical theatre's invisibility. The Furman Pauper Players, named so on account of the group's meager, personally supplied budget, marked the beginning of a new era with their first entirely student-run production of "Nunsense." In the subsequent year, Campbell continued to astound audiences, often parents at Parents' Weekend, with her delightful interpretations of musicals like "Godspell" and "Joseph and the Amazing Technicolor Dreamcoat." Campbell's legacy will continue through primarily student-run musical theatre productions. She began what undoubtedly has become a beloved Furman tradition.

Article I: Name

The name of this organization is the Furman Pauper Players (FPP).

Article II: Purpose

The purpose of FPP is twofold:

1. To perform quality musical theatre productions at Furman University.
2. To provide motivated students of any major or background with the opportunity to sharpen their skills in leadership, communication, performance, cooperation, and responsibility.

Article III: Membership

Section 1

Any interested Furman students are welcome to become members of FPP. After involvement in just one show, a student is considered to be a member of FPP. While auditions are necessary for any stage production, interested students and FPP members who are not cast in any given show will be invited to help with offstage facets of the production—lighting, sound, costumes, props, publicity etc. All members are subject to the terms of this constitution.

Section 2

Members of FPP are eligible to apply for FPP council if they have participated in at least one musical or Cabaret in the last two semesters that they have been on campus. While the shows are being affected by Covid-19 this rule does not apply. Any eligible member of FPP can become a member of the FPP Council by going through the application process released by the current council during the Spring semester.

Section 3

All members of Pauper Players are always bound by University conduct policies, including when representing Pauper Players. If a member is found to have violated the Student Code of Conduct

at a Pauper Players event, rehearsal, or performance in any capacity, they will find themselves ineligible to audition for future Pauper Players performances.

Section 4

Alcohol, drugs, or any other items prohibited by the student conduct code are not permitted under any circumstances at Pauper Players performances, rehearsals, or events.

Article IV: Council

Section 1: Members of Council

The Council will comprise experienced Pauper Players selected through an application process explained in Section V. By a majority vote, the size of Council can increase or decrease as deemed necessary by the current Council. Members of Council are responsible for making executive decisions regarding the performance calendar, show selection, director selection, and any other administrative aspect of the organization. Members of Council who do not hold executive officer positions can perform executive duties in the absence of the elected officers as decided upon by the president. These members can also serve on ad hoc committees formed throughout the year.

Section 2: Executive Officers and Responsibilities

The President shall be responsible for:

1. Presiding over Council meetings.
2. Acting as the primary contact of FPP to the university.
3. Delegating responsibilities to members of the Council and forming committees.
4. Counting votes during Council meetings.
5. Maintaining and updating the Constitution and Bylaws.

The Treasurer shall be responsible for:

1. All fiscal business of FPP
2. Creating a budget to submit to the Student Government Association.
3. Working with SGA to use the allocated budget and request more funds should any be necessary.
4. Deciding upon allocations of the budget within FPP in coordination with the directors of each show.
 - a. Allocations are to be presented to the Council.
5. Working with the Director(s) of each show to keep them aware of their budget allowances and limitations.
6. Acquiring reimbursement from SGA.
7. Making financial reports at Council meetings as appropriate.

The Secretary shall be responsible for:

1. Reserving the space for each Council meeting.
2. Taking attendance at the start of each Council meeting.
3. Taking minutes at each Council meeting.
4. Sending the minutes to all members of the Council and its advisors.

5. Promoting communication within the Council itself.
6. Keeping a list of the active members of FPP.

The Events Coordinator shall be responsible for:

1. Coordinating all Pauper Players events aside from the two major musical productions and cabarets.
2. Reserving the space for such events if necessary.
3. Serving as the liaison between Council and the Director of any cabaret.

The Publicity Committee shall comprise the Public Relations Chair and Social Media Chair:

The Public Relations Chair shall be responsible for:

1. Publicizing FPP itself.
2. Publicizing FPP auditions, performances, and other events around the university and in the community.
3. Obtaining assistance from any members of FPP for publicity purposes whenever necessary.
4. Making publicity reports at Council meetings as appropriate.
5. Ordering promotional material for the Student Involvement Fair in the Fall and Furman Forward in the Spring.

The Social Media Chair shall be responsible for:

1. Publicizing all the above mentioned FPP events through social media accounts including but not limited to Instagram and TikTok.
2. Creating posts and graphics as needed.

The Morale Chair shall be responsible for:

1. Snacks and water for the cast during Tech Week of the two main stage musicals.
2. Getting thank you notes for the production teams of the two major musicals.

The Members at Large will be responsible for:

1. Supporting Executive Council members in their responsibilities when needed.
2. Will coordinate the front of house for main stage production.
3. Serving as a Director Liaisons or Cast Deputies during productions such as cabarets and main stage shows.
 - a. The Director Liaison or Cast Deputy shall be responsible for:
 - i. Attending all production team meetings.
 - ii. Serving as an extra liaison between Council and the production team.
 - iii. Voicing concerns of the Council to the production team and vice versa.
 - iv. This Member at Large should **not** already be a part of the production team.

Section 3: Meetings

The FPP Council will meet biweekly at times decided upon by the Council members. At each meeting, officers will make their weekly reports and any other necessary business will be made known. Each member of Council will be allowed two unexcused absences each semester. For an absence to be excused, you must tell the Secretary prior to the meeting.

Section 4: Council Presence

The FPP Council is to serve the role of producers for each of its productions and its presence needs to be felt by the members of FPP. All members of Council, if they are not already involved in the production, are required to attend at least one rehearsal to check up on progress and see if anything needs to be done by the Council to aid the director or the progress of the show. Each member will report their rehearsal attendance and observations at the following Council meeting.

Section 5: Council Applications & Officer Selection

Members of FPP are eligible to apply for FPP Council if they have participated in at least **one** musical or cabaret in the last two semesters that they have been on campus. Any eligible member of FPP can become a member of the FPP council by going through the application process released by the current Council during the Spring. Any members of council who wish to remain on council must re-apply. Each new officer is chosen by a majority vote of the current Council members that are not running for the position in question, nor the President. The appropriate size of the Council will be determined by the current Council.

Section 6: Provisions for Removal

According to University Policy, "Organizations may not address a member's violations of university policy via internal standards boards or other accountability mechanisms without prior approval of the Dean of Students Office. Conduct expectations unique to membership in the organization and that do not overlap or otherwise interfere with university authority may be addressed with the written approval of the AVP/Dean of Students or designee. Groups affiliated with national organizations that have established guidance and procedures over disciplinary matters, may follow the directive of those national organizations with regard to member conduct but must do so with written approval from the university."

Article V: Productions

Section 1: Director and Production Selection

Any member of FPP, regardless of their position in the organization, is eligible to direct a FPP production, including *Rocky Horror Picture Show*. A student interested in directing must choose the show that they would like to direct, apply using the application released by the current Council in the Spring, and form a proposal to be presented at a Council meeting. The proposal should include creative concepts for the lighting, set, and costume designs, potential production team members, and a tentative budget and timeline for rehearsals including tech week. After all interested parties have made their proposals, the FPP Council will discuss and choose by a majority vote the directors and shows for the upcoming season. Productions and Directors for the next season will be decided upon by the end of the Spring semester the academic year before the upcoming season. In the proceeding Fall semester, the Council will release the Holiday Cabaret Director application and in the early Spring, the Council will release the Spring Cabaret Director application.

Section 2: Responsibilities of the Director

The responsibilities of the directors are as follows:

1. Complete responsibility for the show and has at their disposal the allocated resources of FPP Council.
2. During the preparations for the show, the FPP Council can request to meet with the director at any time to give feedback and suggestions.
3. Communicate regularly with the cast, crew, and Council members to make sure that preparations are going smoothly and are within the show's budget.
4. Attend meetings during the production of their show when needed.
5. Selecting production team members including but not limited to: Music Director, Stage Manager, Lighting Designer, Set Designer, and Choreographer.
6. Deciding upon the attendance policy for rehearsals and making it known to cast and crew at the very beginning of production.
7. Act in a professional manner at all times, since they are representing the entire organization.
8. If a cast or crew member is not fulfilling his/her responsibilities by coming to rehearsal and learning music and lines, the director has the authority to remove them from the show and find a replacement if necessary.
9. Ensuring that a playbill is made for their production.
10. If the FPP Council feels that a director is not fulfilling the aforementioned requirements, the Council may replace the director with a majority vote.
 - a. The issue must be brought to the President who will set up a meeting with the Director. A neutral third Council Member or member of the production team who did not bring up the original complaint will also be present at this meeting. Depending on the discussion, the removal of the Director may or may not be brought to a vote at the following council meeting which will include all members of the Production Team, and the offending Director may be removed if 70% of Council members and every member of the Production Team agrees.
 - b. Should the Director be removed from his/her position, the Council and Production Team will vote on the New Director. In order for someone to be chosen as the New Director, the Production Team must be unanimous and Council must reach a majority.

Section 3: Performances

The Director of McAlister Auditorium will allocate the dates for both of the FPP Mainstage Productions. The number of performances for these two productions is 3.

Article VI: Faculty & Staff Involvement

Section 1: Advisors

The advisors of FPP are any supportive and willing Furman faculty or staff members who will serve as a non-voting member of the organization. The advisors shall assist the group in the execution of roles and responsibilities, provide feedback to the organization regarding its operation and function, and serve as resources to FPP, sharing knowledge, expertise, and experience with the group. As of Spring 2024, the FPP advisors are as follows:

1. Danielle Hernandez
2. Maegan Azar
3. Dr. Stephen Gusukuma

4. Rick Schosky
5. Jessica Lane

Section 2: Liaison from the Music Department

The liaison from the music department is any Furman music faculty member willing to give their support to FPP. The liaison from the music department will assist FPP with synchronizing the music department's and FPP's calendars and encouraging support for the organization from the other members of the music faculty. As of Spring 2024, the FPP Music Department Liaison is Dr. Stephen Gusukuma.

Section 3: Liaison from the Theatre Department

The liaison from the theatre department is any theatre faculty member willing to give his/her support to FPP. The liaison from the theatre department will assist FPP with synchronizing the theatre department's and FPP's calendars and encouraging support for the organization from the other members of the theatre faculty. As of Spring 2024, the FPP Theatre Department Liaison is Maegan Azar.

Section 4: Restrictions

FPP is a completely student-run organization, and faculty advisors and/or liaisons will not be allowed to choose Council members, serve on the Council, and choose directors or shows. Council will inform advisors of any pertinent information.

Article VII: Provisions for Amending the Constitution

Amendments may be made to the FPP Constitution by a majority vote of the members of FPP Council.

Furman Pauper Players Bylaws
Updated Spring 2024

Article I - The President

Section 1: The President of Pauper Players Council cannot serve on the production team for any mainstage show or cabaret (including *Rocky Horror Picture Show*).

Section 2: The President is the spokesperson for members of the cast should there be any issues with the production team. Whether or not they agree with the rest of the cast, the President will speak in their defense and in their best interests, regardless of if they are in the cast or not.

Section 3: The President is the liaison between Council and faculty/staff advisors.

Section 4: The President is allowed to intervene with the production team should there be any issues.

Section 5: The President must prepare an agenda for Council meetings.

Article II - The Treasurer

Section 1: The Treasurer must make a budget report when appropriate.

Section 2: Reimbursements to the production team and payments to the orchestra must be made in a timely manner.

Section 3: Reallocations can be made without a Council vote so long as the Treasurer and Director are in agreement, and the reallocations are approved by SGA.

- There must be a report about reallocations in meetings.

Section 4: The Treasurer must allocate and submit a budget to SGA at the end of the school year.

Section 5: The Treasurer must keep records of all transactions, reallocations, reimbursements, and any other financial activity in writing.

Article III - The Secretary

Section 1: The Secretary must take minutes in all Council meetings and send them to the Council and advisors.

Section 2: The Secretary is responsible for reserving rooms for all meetings.

Article IV - Events Coordinator

Section 1: The Events Coordinator organizes all Front of House business (ushers, rose sales, etc.) during the two main stage productions.

Section 2: The Events Coordinator plans and facilitates all Pauper Players events outside of the mainstage productions, cabarets, and *Rocky Horror Picture Show*, including but not limited to Pauper@PDen Nights and karaoke nights.

Article V - Public Relations Chair

Section 1: The Public Relations Chair is responsible for creating promotional materials for FPP auditions, performances, and other events around the university and in the community.

Section 2: The Public Relations Chair must work collaboratively with the Social Media Chair and director for advertising campaigns.

Section 3: The Public Relations Chair is responsible for coordinating general Pauper Players apparel (T-shirts, hats, etc).

Section 4: The Public Relations Chair is responsible for maintaining the FPP Website.

Article VI - Social Media Chair

Section 1: The Social Media Chair is responsible for updating social media accounts including but not limited to Instagram and TikTok.

Section 2: The Social Media Chair must work collaboratively with the Public Relations Chair and director for advertising campaigns.

Article VII - Morale Chair

Section 1: The Morale Chair must supply snacks and water for the cast during Tech Week of the two mainstage productions and *Rocky Horror Picture Show*.

Section 2: The Morale Chair organizes cast gifts for the production teams of ALL productions, including cabarets.

Article VIII - Members at Large

Section 1: Members at Large must be willing to step into any roles other Council members need of them.

Section 2: At the beginning of each academic year, at least one Member at Large will be elected as a Director Liaison.

- Director Liaisons serve as the point of contact for mainstage production directors and facilitate communication between them and Council.

Article IX - Members of Council

Section 1: If a member of Council is applying to direct a show, they may not be involved in the show decision making process.

Section 2: If a member of Council is included on a potential production team, they may be involved in the show selection process including voting privileges.

Section 3: Members of Council must be involved in at least one FPP production (including mainstage, cabarets, or *Rocky Horror Picture Show*) before their election and every following academic year.

Section 4: Members of Council are responsible for maintaining and updating the Constitution and Bylaws.

Section 5: Council members are the face of Pauper Players and should conduct themselves appropriately.

Article X - Director and Production Rules

Section 1: All members of Pauper Players must remember that we are a student organization, and the spaces we use are a privilege, **not a right**. Those who use the spaces must treat them with respect and follow all guidelines provided by their respective stewards. The Director of each production must be aware of the Furman University Student Organization Policies as well as those of Pauper Players and enforce them by making their cast and team aware early in the production process.

Section 2: Any Music or Theatre majors who wish to audition are required to notify their respective teachers.

- If a professor requires permission forms, the student must comply.

Section 3: Students must not miss classes or music lessons for Pauper Players rehearsals or meetings.

Section 4: Schedules for all rehearsals including tech week must include call time, start time, and end time.

Section 5: Rehearsals must always start and end at the times specified on the schedule. Rehearsals will end no later than 10:00 pm.

Section 6: Notes following tech week rehearsals will only be group notes. Individual notes will be given individually when needed.

Section 7: Directors must keep in consistent contact with the McAlister staff throughout the production.

Article XI - Council Meetings

Section 1: Council Meetings will be scheduled to occur at least once every other week.

Section 2: Attendance will be taken at each meeting by the Secretary. Any more than two unexcused absences will result in probation for the remainder of the semester. Two consecutive semesters of probation result in dismissal from the FPP Council.

Section 3: All regular Council Meetings that do not involve voting processes or Constitution amendments are open to any member of FPP outside of Council.

- Directors who are not on Council must be aware that they are always welcome to attend Council meetings during the production process.

Article XIII - Council Applications & Officer Elections

Section 1: To apply to Council, an applicant must have participated in at least one FPP production of any kind in the last two semesters they were on campus.

Section 2: Officer elections must happen before the director selection process.

Section 3: Application forms are written and revised by the current Council as seen fit.

Section 4: The maximum size of Council is 15 members, and the minimum size of Council is eight members.

Section 5: Council members who wish to serve another year must re-apply.

Section 6: Each officer position is chosen by the graduating seniors and any current Council members that are not running for the specific position.

Section 7: After the seven officer positions are filled, the Members at Large are selected from the pool of remaining applicants by a popular vote of the Council.

Section 8: The Outgoing President and Outgoing Secretary will run the Council election and view the results of the vote.

- The Outgoing President will not have a vote while the Outgoing Secretary will.

Section 9: If a former officer eligible for reelection is not re-elected onto Council in any position, they will not have a vote in show selection.

Section 10: In the event of a tie, the Outgoing President will serve as the tie-breaking vote.

Article XIV - Director and Mainstage Show Selection

Section 1: Show selection voting will only occur after the Director Presentation Process.

Section 2: The Director Presentation Process will consist of a brief presentation followed by questions from Council members until all concerns have been satisfied.

- Potential Directors have 24 hours to respond to questions via email (to the President) if necessary.

Section 3: The directors and mainstage shows will be voted on as a full season and will require a majority vote.